

ABB'S INDIA GROWTH STORY

them effectively.”

Another key lever driving growth is localisation. Recalling the Covid lockdown period, Sharma says the demand profile began to shift, prompting the firm to bring in more products.

“We suddenly found that the market had become far more sophisticated in its demands, with customers increasingly looking to localise,” he says. “That led to a strategic decision to localise our products. Importing complete units is more expensive, but when you localise, your dependence on external supply chains reduces and a domestic supply ecosystem gets built around you. Even if there are shocks, you are better able to manage them.”

Sharma says 90% of the business in India is localised. The intent is to continue localising at a much higher rate. The lower the dependency on dollar or euro imports, the higher the stability in prices.

Rishab Jain, Research Analyst at HDFC Securities, says ABB's execution strength stems from a series of strategic initiatives, including an operating model that decentralises decision-making across 18 divisions, fostering agility and customer proximity, and a “local for local” strategy that leverages five manufacturing locations and 25 shop floors to build resilience. “The company has diversified its presence across 23 market segments, mitigating cyclical risks, while focusing on portfolio premiumisation through high-technology, energy-efficient products that align with sustainability goals,” he adds.

Echoing those views, Priyankar Biswas, Industrials and Logistics Research Analyst at JM Financials Institutional Securities Ltd, says the higher level of localisation and proactive build-up of inventory is a key strength.

On what keeps the company ahead despite intense competition, Sharma points to the strength of customer trust in ABB India's products and solutions, an advantage rooted in its global capabilities and long-standing local presence.

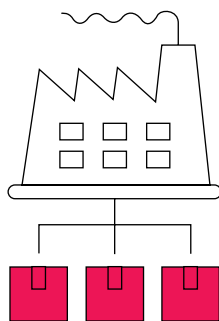
“We have been manufacturing in

01 **Under Sanjeev Sharma, ABB India is aligning its strategy with the country's accelerating industrial capex cycle**

02 **Nearly 90% of business is now localised, reducing reliance on imports and improving supply chain resilience**

03 **The company has expanded from eight to 23 market segments in a decade, spanning manufacturing, infrastructure, railways and data centres**

04 **Segments such as data centres, electrification, metro rail and industrial automation are expected to drive the next phase of growth**



India for 75 years, so customers see us as both a global and a local company,” Sharma says. “They know global quality products are available here. That's our strength. Our serviceability is also very high compared to the competition.”

Another advantage, he adds, is the breadth of the product portfolio, which positions the firm well to grow with an expanding industrial economy. “Our portfolio is wide enough to support an aspiring country like India. We saw the same in China, where we grew rapidly alongside the country's industrial expansion.”

Sharma also credits his team for providing stability. Many members of the leadership team have spent years—often decades—within the organisation, building deep institutional knowledge and a strong understanding of the company's culture and customer-first approach.

According to Jain of HDFC Securities, ABB India's earnings growth is expected to be broad-based, supported by momentum across several key segments. Data centres remain a primary structural driver, accounting for nearly 11% of the order book.

Growth is also expected from railways and metro projects, driven by propulsion systems for Indian Railways and electrification solutions for expanding urban metro networks. The electrification segment is another key pillar, supported by demand for smart power and distribution solutions across infrastructure and renewable energy projects.

Exports, which contribute 10–11% of revenue, remain a strategic focus as the firm expands into newer geographies on the African continent. Meanwhile, the automation business is likely to benefit from a recovery in core sectors such as metals, refining, and chemicals, along with increasing adoption of digitalisation and AI-led industrial solutions.

Under Sharma's leadership, the company is betting that localisation, service and technology will remain its strongest competitive edge. **BT**

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